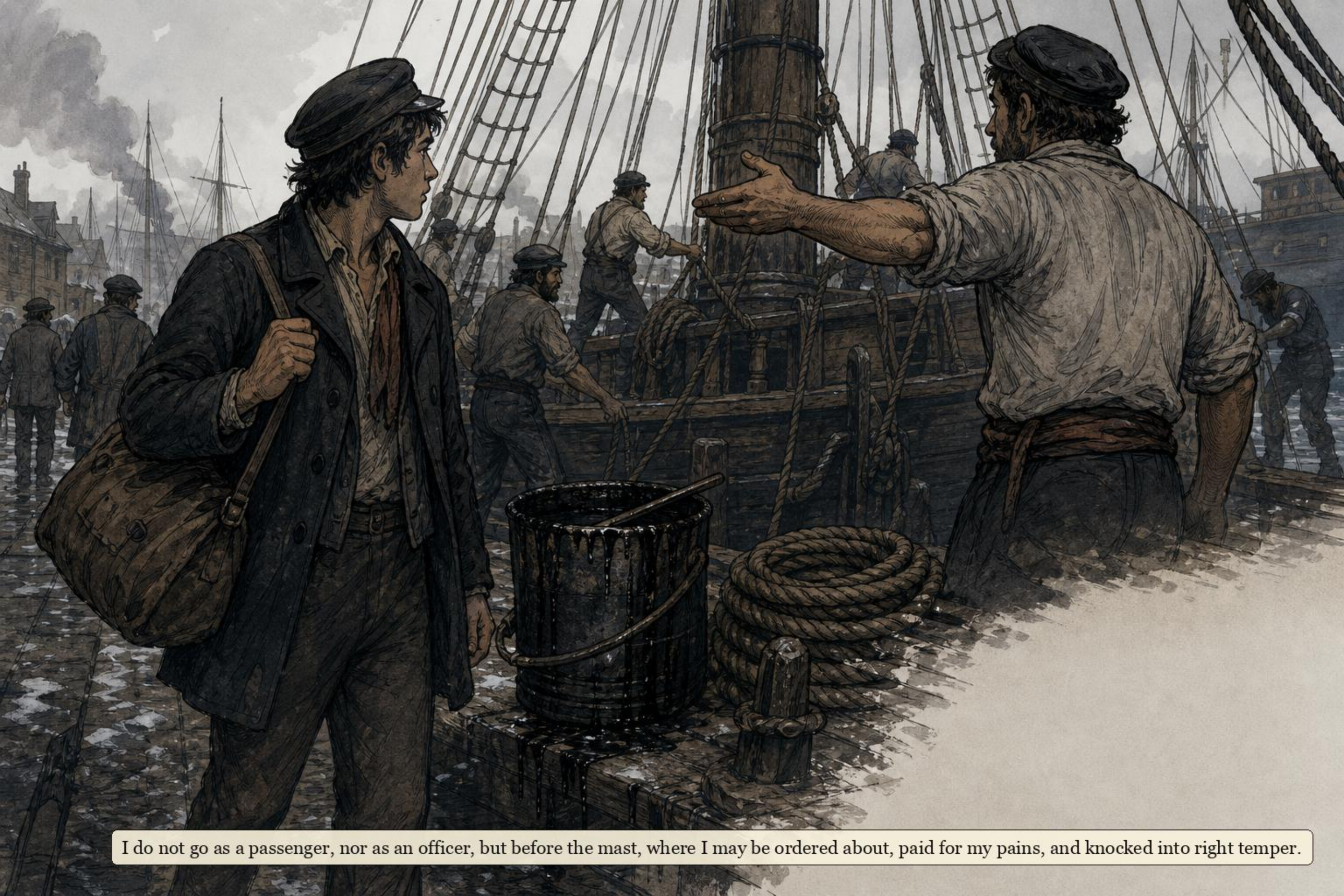
Call me Ishmael.

Whenever I feel that damp, drizzly November in my soul, I know it is high time to get to sea.




I do not go as a passenger, nor as an officer, but before the mast, where I may be ordered about, paid for my pains, and knocked into right temper.

The water draws me, and of all voyages, the whaling voyage draws me most: the great whale opens the wonder-world before me.

